route values to generate a URL.

You can use the `LinkGenerator` class to generate URLs for your minimal APIs. You can use it in any part of your application, so you can use it in middleware and any other services too. `LinkGenerator` has various methods for generating URLs, such as `GetPathByPage` and `GetPathByAction`, which are used specifically for routing to Razor Pages and MVC actions, so we'll look at those in chapter 14. We're interested in the methods related to named routes.

6.4.1 Generating URLs for a minimal API endpoint with LinkGenerator

You'll need to generate URLs in various places in your application, and one common location is your minimal API endpoints. The following listing shows how you could generate a link to one endpoint from another by annotating the target endpoint with a name and using the `LinkGenerator` class.

Listing 6.2 Generating a URL `LinkGenerator` and a named endpoint

```
app.MapGet("/product/{name}", (string name) => $"The product is {name}")  ❶
    .WithName("product");                                                  ❷

app.MapGet("/links", (LinkGenerator links) =>                              ❸
{
    string link = links.GetPathByName("product",                           ❹
        new { name = "big-widget"});                                       ❹
    return $"View the product at {link}";                                  ❺
});
```

❶ The endpoint echoes the name it receives in the route template.

❷ Gives the endpoint a name by adding metadata to it

❸ References the LinkGenerator class in the endpoint handler